Weekly Paper Digest

Generated: 2026-10-31 18:17 Period: 2026-10-15 to 2026-10-30

Total: 34 papers (31 with abstract, 34 with PDF)

Contents

1 Strategy **2**

1.1 Strategic Management Journal . . . 2

1.1.1 1. Materiality and investor reaction to environmental corporate social responsibility: A replication and extension of Flammer (2013) . . . 2

1.1.2 2. Strategy as a theory of change . . . 2

1.1.3 3. Pay-for-prominence: The (un)intended consequences of monetary incentives on employees' networks and attrition . . . 3

1.1.4 4. Investors' ideology and corporate symbolic and substantive climate actions . 4

1.1.5 5. A platform for change? Core component innovations, complementor adaptation, and multihoming in platform-based ecosystems . . . 4

1.2 Administrative Science Quarterly . . . 5

1.2.1 1. Book Review: Maja Bak Herrie. Thinking Through Data: How Outliers, Aggregates, and Patterns Shape Perception . . . 5

1.2.2 2. Book Review: James S. Fishkin. Can Deliberation Cure the Ills of Democracy? FishkinJ. S. (2025). Can deliberation cure the ills of democracy?Oxford University Press, 2025. 192 pp. ISBN 9780198944416 . . . 5

1.2.3 3. Book Review: Joel Gehman, Paula Jarzabkowski, Ann Langley, and Haridimos Tsoukas (Eds). Organizing beyond Organizations for the Common Good: Confronting Societal Challenges through Process Studies GehmanJ.JarzabkowskiP.LangleyA.TsoukasH. (Eds.). (2025). Organizing beyond organizations for the common good: Confronting societal challenges through process studies. Oxford University Press. 272 pp. ISBN 9780198956648 . . . 6

1.3 Academy of Management Review . . . 6

1.3.1 1. Affect-Infused Reflective Process in Responding to Burdensome Role Expectations: An Affect-Cognition Theory Extension of Yagil's "I Don't Want To" . . . 6

1.3.2 2. Breaking the Silence: Developing an Organizational Mental Health Capability 7

1.3.3 3. Taking a Note from Music: Conceptual Sampling and the Creative Logic of Theory Development . . . 7

1.4 Organization Science . . . 8

1.4.1 1. Qualitative Research in the Age of AI: Considerations, Critiques, and Craft . . 8

1.4.2 2. Women's Approachability Premium in Sales: A Field Experiment Among Microentrepreneurs . . . 8

1.4.3 3. Filtering the Labor Pool: How Digitalization Redistributes Hiring Costs 9

1.4.4 4. Action-oriented Narratives. How Innovation Emerges from Crowd Discussions 9

1.4.5 5. Demand for Research and the Composition of Scientific Response: Intellectual Distance, Research Productivity, and Research Outcomes . . . 10

1.5 Academy of Management Journal . . . 10

1.5.1 1. "We're Not Handling Cases, We're Shaping Lives": How Lawyers Preserve Professional Authority and Advance Social Responsibility via Moral Identity-Based Client Persuasion . . . 10

2 Innovation & Entrepreneurship **11**

2.1 Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice . . . 11

2.1.1 1. Belief Traps Hinder Small Business Climate Action . . . 11

2.1.2 2. The Future of Entrepreneurship Research Includes Online Panel Data—If Used Correctly . . . 12
2.2 Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal . . . 12
2.2.1 1. The intelligence loop and value creation in the age of AI agents . . . 12
2.2.2 2. Generative AI use in entrepreneurship: An integrative review and the Empowerment–Entrapment Framework . . . 13
2.2.3 3. Conceptual search: A generative view of entrepreneurial imagination . . . 14
2.2.4 4. "Borrowing intelligence to build a business": The promise of open-source AI for entrepreneurship . . . 15
2.2.5 5. Everything everywhere all-at-once? AI, expertise–output decoupling, and new entrepreneurial strategy trade-offs in the age of abundance . . . 15
2.2.6 6. Generative AI and the ability of entrepreneurial opportunities to generate sustained competitive advantages . . . 16
2.2.7 7. Framing the unknowable: The role of language and frame multiplicity in early-stage startup pitches . . . 17
2.2.8 8. When machines learn with organizations: AI-enabled knowledge creation and entrepreneurship . . . 17

3 General Management **18**
3.1 Journal of Management Studies . . . 18
3.1.1 1. Craft and Industrialization: Uncovering the Plasticity and Frontier of Craft . . . 18
3.1.2 2. It's in the Small Steps: Navigating Knotted Change-Stability Tensions in Complex Collaborations . . . 19
3.1.3 3. CEO Ideologically (In)Congruent Activism and Investor Reactions: An Attribution of CEO Intentions Perspective . . . 19
3.2 Journal of Management . . . 20
3.2.1 1. A Moral Foundations Perspective on CEO Political Ideology . . . 20
3.2.2 2. Competitive Dormancy in Interfirm Rivalry: Consequences for Rival Actions . . . 20
3.2.3 3. "The Minimum Wage Is the Maximum Wage": How Goal Replacement Perpetuates Means–Ends Decoupling . . . 21
3.2.4 4. Winning at Defense by Playing Offense: Discrediting by Target Firms in Activist Hedge Fund Campaigns . . . 21

Strategy

Strategic Management Journal

1. Materiality and investor reaction to environmental corporate social responsibility: A replication and extension of Flammer (2013)

Authors: Steven D. Kofford, Ben W. Lewis, Myles Melancon
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70135
Published: 2026-10-30

Keywords: environmental CSR, event study, investor reaction, materiality, replication

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Social Responsibility, Sustainable Finance
- **Theories:** Financial Materiality, Signaling Theory, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: We replicate and extend Flammer's (2013) event study of investor reaction to environmental corporate social responsibility. Flammer found that investors react positively to eco-friendly events and negatively to eco-harmful events, with posi- tive reactions diminishing and negative reactions intensifying from 1980 to 2009. We confirm her results in a narrow replication and find that these time trends per- sist in a quasi-replication extending the sample through 2019, despite major shifts in the institutional environ- ment for sustainability investing. We then extend Flam- mer by incorporating financial materiality and find that the investor reactions and time trends Flammer observed are primarily concentrated in material events. Notably, investors drew this distinction throughout the 40-year window we study, predating the institutionali- zation of materiality-based sustainability analysis. All authors contributed equally and are listed in alphabetical order. Received: 27 February 2025 Revised: 1 July 2026 Accepted: 18 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70135 © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–24. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Managerial Summary: We examine how investors respond to companies' environmental actions. Analyz- ing 40 years of data on US-listed public firms, we find that investors reward companies for eco-friendly actions and penalize them for harmful ones. Over time, these reactions have shifted: investors have grown less enthusiastic about eco-friendly actions and more criti- cal of harmful ones. Importantly, investors react pri- marily to environmental actions that are financially relevant, or "material," to the business and were doing so well before formal standards existed. Within material actions, positive reactions to eco-friendly initiatives have weakened while negative reactions to eco-harmful ones have grown stronger. These findings suggest that managers should prioritize environmental initiatives closely tied to their company's financial performance. K E Y W O R D S environmental CSR, event study, investor reaction, materiality, replication 1 |

Kofford - Materiality and investor reaction to environmental corporate social responsibi

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2. Strategy as a theory of change

Authors: Sergio G. Lazzarini, Todd R. Zenger, Teppo Felin
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70139
Published: 2026-10-30

Keywords: causal maps, directed graph, theory of change, theory-based view of strategy

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Theory-Based View, Causal Mapping, Systems Thinking

Abstract:

Research Summary: The theory-based view argues that a strategist's task is to develop a theory to move the

orga- nization to an improved future state. Focusing on theoriz- ing as a thought process of model creation, we propose a framework to specify hypothetical causal links and ana- lyze their structure as a directed graph connecting inputs, activities, and indicators of problem resolution. We then propose a set of metrics operationalizing key theory attri- butes: complexity, equifinality, interdependence, and cir- cularity. We discuss the strategic relevance of these attributes in terms of a theory's ability to promote compre- hensive problem resolution as well as implement, evalu- ate, and replicate the proposed solution. Our work represents a step toward operationalizing model creation in the theory-based view and informs the design of strategic theories of change. Managerial Summary: Strategists often theorize how to move their organizations toward an improved perfor- mance state. Yet most strategic analysis tools describe the organization's external environment or the internal components of its business model, without precisely specifying forward-looking interventions that might cause the desired changes. In this paper, we represent strategic theories as a chain of causal interventions—Received: 18 December 2024 Revised: 28 September 2026 Accepted: 15 October 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70139 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–27. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 inputs and activities that address relevant problems and lead to desirable outcomes. We propose a structured framework that helps managers develop theories and measure key attributes that influence comprehensive problem resolution and the ability to implement, evalu- ate, and replicate the proposed interventions. In this sense, our work helps managers mentally create their strategic theories and assess their usefulness as a roadmap to superior performance. K E Y W O R D S causal maps, directed graph, theory of change, theory-based view of strategy 1 |

 Lazzarini - Strategy as a theory of change.pdf

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3. Pay-for-prominence: The (un)intended consequences of monetary incentives on employees' networks and attrition

Authors: Alessandro Iorio, Giuseppe Soda, Brandy Aven
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70133
Published: 2026-10-22

Keywords: attrition, field quasi-experiment, incentives, intervention, social networks

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Human Capital, Organizational Behavior, Social Network Analysis
- **Theories:** Social Network Theory, Relational Incentives Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: We introduce the concept of pay-for-prominence, a system where employees are monetarily incentivized to become knowledge hubs in the intrafirm network and examine its effects on employees' networks and attrition. Integrating social network theory with relational incentives theory, we argue that pay-for-prominence motivates strategic net- working behaviors that lead to the emergence of promi- nent connectors. However, these changes are associated with higher attrition as employees are preoccupied with networking, thus suggesting a trade-off between enhanced connectivity in the short term and the risk of network fragmentation in the long term. Using a field quasi-experiment in a multinational firm, we show that organizations can successfully incentivize employees' network prominence, but doing so may produce unintended consequences. Managerial Summary: We examine the impact of using monetary incentives to encourage employees to become knowledge hubs in the workplace informal Received: 28 July 2026 Revised: 28 July 2026 Accepted: 7 September 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70133 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–34. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 network—a term we label pay-for-prominence. We find that offering monetary rewards based on network met- rics encourages employees to broaden their connec- tions, enhancing knowledge flows within the firm. However, employees who become more socially promi- nent experience higher attrition than those who do not, as they become preoccupied with networking. There- fore, while incentivizing networking can improve knowledge sharing, it also requires careful manage- ment to avoid unintended consequences, such as the exit of key players that could cause fragmentation of the social network. Managers should weigh the benefits of increased connectivity against the risks of fragmenta- tion when designing incentive programs aimed at

fos- tering informal networks. K E Y W O R D S attrition, field quasi-experiment, incentives, intervention, social networks 1 |

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4. Investors' ideology and corporate symbolic and substantive climate actions

Authors: Chang Liu, Wei Shi
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70137
Published: 2026-10-19

Keywords: corporate governance, decoupling, institutional investor, political ideology, political polarization, sustainability

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Corporate Governance, Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Decoupling, Upper Echelons Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Prior research suggests that institutional investors' liberalism is associated with firms' engagement in environmental sustainability, yet whether this association manifests in symbolic or sub- stantive actions remains unclear. Taking a question- driven approach, our analyses of Russell 3000 firms (2010–2020) reveal that investor liberalism, measured as the proportion of donations made to the Democratic Party, is positively associated with symbolic climate actions only from 2016 onward (a period when political polarization intensified), reversing a negative associa- tion during 2010–2015. Its positive association with substantive actions from 2016 onward, however, appears only among consistent Democratic donors (stronger liberal values), among dedicated investors, or in firms without CEO duality (greater investor influence). These findings indicate that liberal investor own- ership may encourage, rather than deter, firms' environmental decoupling. Managerial Summary: Liberal institutional investors tend to favor greater corporate environmental sustain- ability efforts, but are they associated with firms' Received: 9 April 2026 Revised: 12 August 2026 Accepted: 5 October 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70137 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–36. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 symbolic or substantive climate actions? Our findings based on U.S. firms reveal that across the full 2010–2020 period, firms with more liberal investors, as indi- cated by their Democratic-leaning political donations, do not exhibit more symbolic or substantive climate actions. From 2016 onward, as political polarization intensified, firms with more liberal investors exhibited more symbolic climate actions but not substantive ones. During this period, only investors with stronger liberal commitment (i.e., consistent Democratic donors) are associated with more substantive actions. Democratic- donating investors are also associated with more sub- stantive actions when they are dedicated investors or when firm CEOs do not chair their boards. K E Y W O R D S corporate governance, decoupling, institutional investor, political ideology, political polarization, sustainability 1 |

 Liu - Investors' ideology and corporate symbolic and substantive climate actions.pdf

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5. A platform for change? Core component innovations, complementor adaptation, and multihoming in platform-based ecosystems

Authors: Shiva Agarwal, Ram Ranganathan
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70136
Published: 2026-10-16

Keywords: competition, ecosystems, evolution, innovation, platforms

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Ecosystems, Digital Platforms
- **Theories:** Platform Governance, Architectural Innovation, Complementor Strategy

Abstract:

Research Summary: Digital platforms coordinate complementor innovations through interfaces into their core components. However, when interfaces themselves evolve alongside core component innovations, com- plementors may exhibit behaviors that are not entirely predictable. Using granular data from Apple's five major iOS releases, we abductively examine App devel- opers' responses following Apple's core component innovations. We document that, in post-release periods, complementors simultaneously increase co-innovation on iOS while being more likely to multihome by diver- sifying to the competing platform. These choices are further explained by whether architectural changes reflect cross-platform standardization or platform- specific differentiation. Standardization spurs both complementor co-innovation and multihoming, while differentiation reduces diversification tendencies. The patterns that we document reveal an important tension: governing through interfaces enables platforms' Authors contributed equally and are listed in alphabetical order of last name. Received: 27 April 2026 Revised: 9 August 2026 Accepted: 1 September 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70136 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–36. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 scalability but constrains their ability to control com- plementors as platforms evolve. Managerial Summary: Digital platforms like Apple coordinate large scale innovation through standardized interfaces, but those interfaces must evolve as platforms compete, and the direction of that evolution has conse- quences managers should attend to. Analyzing Apple's five major iOS releases, we find that architectural changes are associated with increased co-innovation but also a higher likelihood that developers diversify to a competing platform. This pattern is particularly pro- nounced when updates bring iOS closer to Android, suggesting that architectural convergence may lower the barriers to cross-platform expansion for developers. Importantly, this behavior is strongest among highest- value developers. Platform managers should therefore treat architectural evolution not merely as a technical decision, but as a strategic one with direct implications for ecosystem loyalty, competitive differentiation, and the retention of valuable ecosystem partners. K E Y W O R D S competition, ecosystems, evolution, innovation, platforms 1 |

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Administrative Science Quarterly

1. Book Review: Maja Bak Herrie. Thinking Through Data: How Outliers, Aggregates, and Patterns Shape Perception

Authors: Saku Mantere
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261495943
Published: 2026-10-21

Abstract not available. Mantere - Book Review Maja Bak Herrie. Thinking Through Data How Outliers, Aggregates, and.pdf

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2. Book Review: James S. Fishkin. Can Deliberation Cure the Ills of Democracy? FishkinJ. S. (2025). Can deliberation cure the ills of democracy?Oxford University Press, 2025. 192 pp. ISBN 9780198944416

Authors: Ilana Redstone
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261498050
Published: 2026-10-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Political Science, Public Policy, Organizational Theory, Social Psychology
- **Theories:** Deliberative Democracy, Institutional Theory, Social Identity Theory, Democratic Theory

Abstract:

James Fishkin has spent more than three decades running Deliberative Polls-roughly 150 of them, on six continents, with topics ranging from Mongolian constitutional reform to South Korea's 2017 decision on completing the Shin Gori nuclear reactors.A Deliberative Poll convenes a randomly sampled microcosm of the relevant population to discuss a policy question, working through balanced briefing materials and expert panels, with measurements of opinions taken before and after.Can Deliberation Cure the Ills of Democracy? is his compact synthesis of that career.The book asks whether the accumulated empirical record supports a constructive theory of democratic redesign, and answers with a qualified yes.Deliberation, Fishkin argues, can depolarize partisan divisions, produce more thoughtful voters, and help protect the procedural guardrails of electoral democracy-provided that deliberation is institutionalized systematically rather than staged as an occasional showpiece.The book's argument proceeds in five chapters.The first frames the crisis: democratic recession abroad, extreme polarization in the U.S., rising attraction to technocratic and authoritarian alternatives, and a communication environment in which propaganda, social-media enclaves, and partisan priming distort the public's apparent will.The second chapter develops four criteria for popular control over who governs and what decisions are made: inclusion on an equal basis, meaningful choice among alternatives, deliberation on the merits, and impact on actual decisions.The third locates deliberation historically, from the Athenian Council of 500 BCE through James Madison's Federalist-era hopes for representative refinement in the United States, and presents Deliberative Polling as a modern way to convene a randomly sampled microcosm under balanced conditions.The fourth chapter delivers the empirical core, drawn from the "America in One Room" (p.81) experiments in which nationally representative samples of citizens convened, in person and online, to deliberate on contested policy questions over multi-day events, with their views measured before and after and compared against a control group that did not deliberate.The fifth chapter translates the findings into an institutional agenda.The empirical core is the heart of the book, and it is striking.At the 2019 "America in One Room" event, Republican support for forcing undocumented immigrants to return to their home countries fell 39 points after a weekend of moderated discussion; support for the U.S. immigration policy Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals rose 25 points among Republicans.Democrats' support for a $15 federal minimum wage fell 24 points as rural participants raised concerns about small-business viability, and Democratic support for a proposed "baby bond" (p.84) program fell 41 points-the largest single movement...

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3. Book Review: Joel Gehman, Paula Jarzabkowski, Ann Langley, and Haridimos Tsoukas (Eds). Organizing beyond Organizations for the Common Good: Confronting Societal Challenges through Process Studies GehmanJ.JarzabkowskiP.LangleyA.TsoukasH. (Eds.). (2025). Organizing beyond organizations for the common good: Confronting societal challenges through process studies. Oxford University Press. 272 pp. ISBN 9780198956648

Authors: Fannie Couture, Jean-François Soublière
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261500415
Published: 2026-10-23

Abstract not available. Couture - Book Review Joel Gehman, Paula Jarzabkowski, Ann Langley, and Haridimos Tsoukas.pdf

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Academy of Management Review

1. Affect-Infused Reflective Process in Responding to Burdensome Role Expectations: An Affect-Cognition Theory Extension of Yagil's "I Don't Want To"

Authors: Chang Su, Xiaoran Hu
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2025.0873
Published: 2026-10-28

Abstract not available. Su - Affect-Infused Reflective Process in Responding to Burdensome Role Expectations.pdf

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2. Breaking the Silence: Developing an Organizational Mental Health Capability

Authors: Abbie Griffith Oliver, Jeffrey B. Lovelace
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2023.0182
Published: 2026-10-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Human Resource Management, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Dynamic Capabilities Theory, Positive Organizational Scholarship, Social Capital Theory

Abstract:

Organizations invest heavily in mental health resources, yet employee utilization remains strikingly low. This disconnect may signal low need but often masks latent demand: the unobserved gap between employees' mental health needs and their expressed demand for support. Latent demand persists when organizational and individual barriers suppress recognition, access, and permission to seek help, confronting organizations with a capability-building challenge: the conditions sustaining latent demand also suppress the information needed to address it. Because this problem requires organizational adaptation, dynamic capabilities theory offers a starting point. Under latent demand, however, sensing can misread silence as sufficiency, seizing can leave resources unused, and transforming can learn from biased feedback. Integrating dynamic capabilities with positive organizational scholarship, we theorize how organizations develop an organizational mental health capability to recognize, act on, and adapt to employees' observable and latent needs. We identify positive social capital as the bridging mechanism that scales relational micro-practices into organizational infrastructure through stage-contingent structural, relational, and cognitive pathways, each addressing a binding constraint. Our theory extends dynamic capabilities to contexts where information is suppressed rather than merely noisy, shows how positive organizational scholarship enables capability building under latent demand, and advances a macro-level perspective on workplace mental health.

 Oliver - Breaking the Silence Developing an Organizational Mental Health Capability.pdf

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3. Taking a Note from Music: Conceptual Sampling and the Creative Logic of Theory Development

Authors: Quinetta M. Roberson, Phillip S. Thompson
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2026.0377
Published: 2026-10-20

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Management Scholarship, Theory Development, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Conceptual Sampling, Creative Logic of Theory Development

Abstract:

How do scholars develop new theoretical explanations from existing ideas? Although management research has established clear criteria for evaluating theoretical contributions, it has devoted comparatively less attention to the creative processes through which those contributions are generated. In cumulative knowledge systems, theorists rarely develop ideas from entirely new conceptual materials. Instead, they build on existing concepts, mechanisms, and explanations to generate new theoretical insights. This review essay introduces conceptual sampling as a process framework for understanding creative theorizing in management. Drawing on scholarship on music sampling in jazz, electronic music, and hip-hop, we argue that theorizing often proceeds through three distinct processes of conceptual transformation: (1) rearticulation, (2) recombination, and (3) recontextualization. These processes respectively deepen existing theoretical frameworks, build new explanations by integrating ideas across literatures, and extend concepts into new contexts. By integrating scholarship on music sampling with work on theory development, this essay illuminates how scholars transform established conceptual resources into new theoretical explanations, thereby advancing insights on theory development in management.

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Organization Science

1. Qualitative Research in the Age of AI: Considerations, Critiques, and Craft

Authors: Andrew Nelson, Anne-Laure Fayard, Alex Murray
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2026.ed.v37.n6
Published: 2026-10-26

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Qualitative Research Methods, Organizational Theory, Artificial Intelligence
- **Theories:** Technological Affordances, Methodological Craft, Critical Perspective

Abstract:

aLundquist College of Business, University of Oregon, Eugene, Oregon 97403; bNova School of Business and Economics, 2775-405 Carcavelos,

Nelson - Qualitative Research in the Age of AI Considerations, Critiques, and Craft.pdf

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2. Women's Approachability Premium in Sales: A Field Experiment Among Microentrepreneurs

Authors: Solène Delecourt, Laura Doering, Odyssia Ng
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.18859
Published: 2026-10-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Gender Studies, Sales and Marketing
- **Theories:** Social Exchange Theory, Gender Stereotypes, Interactionist Lens

Abstract:

Female entrepreneurs consistently earn less than their male counterparts, a dispar ity that is particularly acute among microentrepreneurs in developing economies. Researchers often attribute this gap to structural constraints but pay less attention to how social interac tions shape earnings. This oversight is especially relevant in microentrepreneurship, where sales are contingent on customers approaching and interacting with sellers in the marketplace. Using an interactionist lens, we draw on social exchange theory and research on gender stereotypes to guide expectations. We anticipate that customers will more often approach female sellers, expecting warmer interactions, and that this higher volume of customers will translate into higher earnings when business characteristics and selling behavior are held con stant. Existing research hints at this dynamic, but methodological constraints have obscured it. To overcome these constraints and test our theory, we conducted a field experiment in two face-to-face markets in India. We trained confederate sellers to run identical, de novo microen terprises and follow standard protocols for customer engagement, thus isolating customer approach in response to sellers' gender. Female sellers attracted 41% more customers, result ing in significantly higher sales than men, all else equal, in our experiment. Consistent with our theory, customers were more likely to talk with women about topics unrelated to the sale and attempt to bargain with women. This study advances research on gender dynamics in entrepreneurship, negotiation, and customer-facing work by identifying customer approach as a novel mechanism that can generate economic advantages for female microentrepreneurs and may shape gendered opportunities in other markets and organizations. Funding: Weiss Family Program Fund for Research in Development Economics, Harvard University (with Odyssia Ng) Stanford King Center on Global Development, Stanford University (with Odys sia Ng) BRAC-CEGA Travel Grant, Center for Effective Global Action, UC Berkeley, (with Odyssia Ng), Global Policy Fellows Research Grant, The Freeman Spogli Institute for International Studies, Stanford University, 2017–2018 (with Odyssia Ng), Diversity Dissertation Research Opportunity, Vice Provost for Graduate Education, Stanford University, 2017–2018 (with Odyssia Ng), Graduate Research Opportunity, School of Humanities and Sciences, Stanford University, 2017–2018 (with Odyssia Ng), Enhancing Diversity in Graduate Education Doctoral Fellowship, Research & Confer ence Travel Award, Vice Provost for Graduate Education, Stanford University, Graduate Student Re-

search Fellowship, Center for South Asia, Stanford University George P. Shultz Graduate Student Fellowship in Economic Policy, Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (with Odyssia Ng), PhD I-Award, Stanford Institute for Innovation in Developing Economies. Supplemental...

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3. Filtering the Labor Pool: How Digitalization Redistributes Hiring Costs

Authors: Moshe A. Barach
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19407
Published: 2026-10-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Human Capital, Digital Labor Markets, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Search and Matching Theory, Signaling Theory, Information Asymmetry

Abstract:

I theorize that candidate filters, a core technology in digital labor markets consid ered central to cost-effective matching, redistributes costs from the search-and-screening stage to the job-offer stage of hiring. Filters cause employers to focus on applicants who dis play common preferred characteristics. At the search-and-screening stage, filters reduce the number of applicants interviewed and alter the composition of the interviewed pool by removing both lower and higher quality candidates. At the job-offer stage, filters lead employers to make job offers to candidates with easily observable signals of quality and higher wage demands. Additionally, I theorize that, if many firms target the same signals of quality, they may all pursue similar candidates. This increases bargaining power for those applicants, leading to more rejected job offers and higher wage demands. A random ized field experiment in a large online labor market confirms that filters redistribute hiring costs. The experiment shows that employers with access to filters interview 3.4% fewer applicants. Using a machine learning algorithm to proxy for unobservable-to-the-employer applicant quality, I show that filters cause employers to interview 28.9% fewer lower qual ity applicants and 36.9% fewer high-quality applicants per job. Among employers who actively used filters, I find suggestive evidence of worse job-offer outcomes: offers are 8.9% more likely to be rejected, and contracted wages are 2.5% higher. I discuss the implications of this cost redistribution for organizations, labor markets, and strategy research. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19407.

 Barach - Filtering the Labor Pool How Digitalization Redistributes Hiring Costs.pdf

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4. Action-oriented Narratives. How Innovation Emerges from Crowd Discussions

Authors: Claudio Biscaro, Arvind Malhotra, Ann Majchrzak
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19136
Published: 2026-10-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Crowdsourcing, Organizational Communication
- **Theories:** Narrative Theory, Discursive Analysis, Collective Problem Solving

Abstract:

Crowds are increasingly invited to tackle complex innovation problems. However, our understanding of how crowds solve these problems has limited our ability to utilize them effectively. In this article, we examine how a crowd tasked with finding ways to preserve New Zealand' s native flora and fauna achieves solutions to this complex innovation problem through discussion. Our analysis reveals that discussions leading to innovative solutions differ from those leading to non-innovative solutions: innovation-yielding discussions (1) mobilize more Resources than Constraints, (2) converge on a single Goal, and (3) specify few (often one) responsible Subject(s); vis-à-vis, discussions leading to non-innovative solutions often surfaced multiple goals —thereby sustaining multiple problem framings—while subjects remained vague, implicit, or multiplied,

and constraints frequently outnumbered resources. Moreover, we show how the specific weavings of these discursive elements support the crowd' s navigation of the complex innovation problem. Three discursive maneuvers –subject-goal anchoring, repurposing distant knowledge, and layering resources –are fundamental navigational tools used by the crowd to form what we call 'action-oriented narratives:' simple, dynamic, and evolving linguistic structures that enable collective problem exploration while giving room for localized improvisation. We contribute to the literature on problem solving by showing how specific linguistic activities alter individuals' capacity to contribute to and solve complex problems. We also contribute to the literature on linguistic structures supporting innovation by showing that the types of discussions that support innovation depend on the openness of the setting. Page 2 of 119 https://pubsonline.informs.org/journal/orsc 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30 31 32 33 34 35 36 37 38 39 40 41 42 43 44 45 46 47 48 49 50 51 52 53 54 55 56 57 58 59 60

Biscaro - Action-oriented Narratives. How Innovation Emerges from Crowd Discussions.pdf

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5. Demand for Research and the Composition of Scientific Response: Intellectual Distance, Research Productivity, and Research Outcomes

Authors: Jino Lu
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2023.17926
Published: 2026-10-30

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Economics of Science, Innovation Management, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Knowledge Recombination, Demand-Pull Innovation, Intellectual Distance

Abstract:

When demand for research in a domain increases, scientific progress depends not only on whether more research is produced, but also on which scientists produce that research. This distinction is especially important in emerging domains, where technological trajectories remain uncertain and progress often requires the generation and integration of heterogeneous scientific knowledge. This study examines how academic scientists respond when demand for research increases in a domain and what research outcomes they produce within that domain. Empirically, I exploit the Zero Emission Vehicle (ZEV) mandate, which led to an unanticipated increase in demand for electric vehicle (EV) research. I find that scientists became more likely to produce EV research after the mandate. However, this response varied systematically across scientists: as intellectual distance from the EV domain increased, more-productive scientists were less responsive than less-productive scientists. Yet among scientists who produced EV research, the research outcomes of scientists from more distant domains were associated with greater novelty, while those of more-productive scientists from more distant domains were associated with greater scientific impact and greater use in downstream EV inventions. These findings suggest that increased demand for research shapes not only the volume of scientific activity in a domain, but also the composition of scientists who produce that research.

Lu - Demand for Research and the Composition of Scientific Response Intellectual Dist.pdf

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Academy of Management Journal

1. "We' re Not Handling Cases, We' re Shaping Lives" : How Lawyers Preserve Professional Authority and Advance Social Responsibility via Moral Identity-Based Client Persuasion

Authors: Siyin Chen, Qiusi Yan
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2025.0366
Published: 2026-10-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Business Ethics, Organizational Behavior, Professional Service Firms
- **Theories:** Moral Identity Theory, Professional Authority, Relational Expertise, Identity Work

Abstract:

Professionals are increasingly expected to deliver socially responsible services that protect vulnerable third parties, yet their authority may be threatened when such recommendations appear to conflict with clients' perceived self-interests and desired end goals. Drawing on a qualitative study of 91 legal cases in China, we examine how lawyers navigate this tension when persuading initially resistant clients to accept socially responsible counsel. We develop a process model of "moral identity-based client persuasion," a form of relational expertise that enables lawyers to preserve professional authority by reconstructing clients' desired end goals to incorporate third-party welfare. The process begins with client moral identity discernment, through which lawyers determine whether a client's moral identity is situationally salient. It unfolds through three linked practices: (1) articulating moral identity threats, (2) providing moral identity affirmations, and (3) legitimizing moral identity enactments. Together, these practices render socially responsible counsel both self-relevant and technically defensible to clients. We further identify three client-level inhibitors of success: insufficient moral identity salience, entangled decision locus, and limited emotional resilience. These findings augment research on professional work by identifying a novel form of relational expertise that mobilizes clients' personal identities to secure compliance, and extend moral persuasion research into professional service contexts.

Chen - "We're Not Handling Cases, We're Shaping Lives"How Lawyers Preserve Professiona.pdf

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Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. Belief Traps Hinder Small Business Climate Action

Authors: Jeffrey Lees, Sara M. Constantino, Jean Cushen, Frederik Dahlmann, Frank G. A. de Bakker, Edoardo Della Torre, Maria Laura Frigotto, Mario Hackenbuchner, Nico Heuvinck, Emmanuel Kypraios, Anastasia Ri, Stephen Roper, Elke Schuessler, Christoph Ungemach, Dror Etzion
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261485958
Published: 2026-10-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Sustainability Management, Social Psychology, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Social Learning Theory, Mimetic Isomorphism, Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Social Inference Theory

Abstract:

Climate (in)action by small business owners is not driven only by policy or economic considera- tions but also by sociological and psychological factors, as leaders mimic the behaviors they per- ceive among their peers. We find that these social inferences about what others believe are often incorrect. In this registered report of 4,432 small-to-medium business owners and leaders across seven countries, we observe a persistent gap between perceived and actual beliefs. And this gap matters: small-to-medium enterprise owners exhibiting a larger gap have fewer sustainability poli- cies in place. These results highlight how peer effects can spur climate action among business leaders. 1Department of Human Resource Management and Organizational Behavior, University of Groningen, The Netherlands 2Department of Environmental Social Sciences, Doerr School of Sustainability, Stanford University, USA 3School of Public and International Affairs, Princeton University, USA 4School of Business, Maynooth University, Ireland 5Warwick Business School, University of Warwick, UK 6IESEG School of Management, University of Lille, CNRS, UMR 9221 - LEM- Lille Economie Management, Lille, France 7Department of Economics, Management and Quantitative Methods, University of Milan, Italy 8Department of Economics and Management, University of Trento, Italy 9Institute of Organization Science, Johannes Kepler University, Linz, Austria 10Institute of Management and Organization, Leuphana University, Lu¨neburg, Germany 11Linz Institute of Transformative Change, Johannes Kepler University, Linz, Austria 12Nuremberg Institute of Market Decisions, Germany 13Grossman School of Business, University of Vermont, USA Corresponding Authors: Jeffrey Lees, Faculty of Economics & Business, University of Groningen, Duisenberg Building (Room 357), Nettelbosje 2, 9747 AE Groningen, The Netherlands. Email: j.m.lees@rug.nl Dror Etzion, Grossman School of Business, University of Vermont, 55 Colchester Ave, 312

Kalkin Hall, Burlington, VT 05405, USA. Email: dror.etzion@uvm.edu

 Lees - Belief Traps Hinder Small Business Climate Action.pdf

2. The Future of Entrepreneurship Research Includes Online Panel Data—If Used Correctly

Authors: Jeffrey M. Pollack, J. Jeffrey Gish, Timothy L. Michaelis, Jeni L. Burnette, David J. Scheaf, Jon C. Carr, Nicholas A. Smith
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261496321
Published: 2026-10-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Research Methodology, Behavioral Sciences
- **Theories:** Generalizability Theory, Sampling Theory, Methodological Rigor

Abstract:

As online panel data (OPD) become more widely used across the behavioral sciences, editors, reviewers, and researchers in entrepreneurship are asking whether it has a legitimate place in our field. We believe the answer is yes—provided three conditions are met. First, the online panel' s participants and definition of entrepreneur must match the research question. Second, studies must incorporate best practices for sample verification. Third, generalizability must be explicitly addressed as part of the study (or set of studies). If researchers do these things, OPD can meaningfully advance both theory and practice in entrepreneurship research. That said, real questions remain. What kinds of studies are suitable for OPD? Who are these respondents, and are they who they say they are? Are they human, and are they entrepreneurs as commonly defined in the literature? Our recommendations and checklist aim to enable entrepreneurship researchers to answer these questions and make informed choices when collecting data and publishing results using OPD.

 Pollack - The Future of Entrepreneurship Research Includes Online Panel Data—If Used Corre.pdf

Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. The intelligence loop and value creation in the age of AI agents

Authors: Yong Li, Ming Zeng, Alexis Li
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70067
Published: 2026-10-30

Keywords: agentic capability, AI agents, intelligence compounding, intelligence loop, minimum viable intelligence, supply-side entrepreneurial opportunity

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Innovation Management, Information Systems
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Dynamic Capabilities, Data Network Effects, Intelligence Loop Mechanism

Abstract:

Research Summary: Artificial intelligence (AI) is moving from generating outputs to executing work. An agent that executes work autonomously produces something genera- tive AI does not: operational experience that can raise its future intelligence. Prior research on AI emphasizes value creation through demand-side feedback, notably data net- work effects, in which user data improve prediction and reinforce adoption. We develop the supply-side counter- part, the intelligence loop: delegated usage generates opera- tional experience, agentic capability converts it into future intelligence, and the resulting value maintains or expands usage. The loop cannot operate until autonomous execution is viable, a threshold we call minimum viable intelligence (MVI). Crossing MVI does not guarantee rising intelligence. Comparable deployments of AI agents can diverge as their loops decay, sustain, or accelerate. Three implications fol- low. Competitive advantage may depend more on the loop than on installed base. An above-MVI agent supplies scarce expert skill as a

non-rival, replicable resource, so productive capacity can grow faster than expert headcount, with the one-person company as a limiting case. And a venture with Received: 17 September 2026 Revised: 22 September 2026 Accepted: 1 October 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70067 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited and is not used for commercial purposes. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–38. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 adequate demand, capital, and a capable team can still fail because its loop never functions or later deteriorates. Managerial Summary: Artificial intelligence (AI) agents can execute work, and the experience generated through execu- tion can raise their future intelligence, a feedback process we call the intelligence loop. An agent crosses a workflow's minimum viable intelligence (MVI) when it executes reliably without step-by-step direction, autonomous execution cre- ates at least as much net value as the best alternative after oversight and correction costs, and governance arrange- ments keep residual risk acceptable and accountability clear. Investment belongs where one of these conditions keeps a valuable workflow below MVI. Deployment can begin with narrow, feedback-rich workflows near MVI that ideally lead to harder workflows, since base model upgrades can match gains on simple work. Even above MVI, the loop is not auto- matic: it stalls when feedback is not timely...

 Li - The intelligence loop and value creation in the age of AI agents.pdf

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2. Generative AI use in entrepreneurship: An integrative review and the Empowerment–Entrapment Framework

Authors: Jackson G. Lu, Gerui Gloria Zhao, Anna Manyi Zheng
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70050
Published: 2026-10-27

Keywords: entrepreneurial process, entrepreneurship, generative AI, human resources, organizational behavior, strategic management, trade-offs

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** Entrepreneurial Process Model, Cognitive Psychology, Empowerment-Entrapment Framework, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

Research Summary: Despite the growing use of generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) in entrepreneurship, research on its impact remains fragmented. To address this limitation, we provide an integrative, entrepreneur-centered review of how GenAI influences entrepreneurs at each stage of the entrepreneurial process: (1) opportunity recognition and ideation, (2) opportunity evaluation and commitment, (3) resource assembly and mobilization, and (4) venture launch and growth. Based on our review, we propose the Empowerment–Entrapment Framework, which not only catalogs GenAI's benefits and costs throughout the entrepreneurial process but also identifies potential trade-offs underlying GenAI's double-edged role. For example, GenAI may improve venture idea quality yet produce hallucinations and biases; boost entrepreneurial self-efficacy yet heighten overconfidence; increase functional breadth and self- sufficiency yet reduce prosociality; and enhance productivity yet diminish cognitive engagement, learning, and memory. We also identify features of GenAI that underlie these empowering and entrapping effects. Moreover, we explore boundary conditions that moderate GenAI's effects, including Received: 31 March 2026 Revised: 16 September 2026 Accepted: 24 September 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70050 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–36. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 entrepreneurs' expertise, approaches to GenAI use, and per- sonal traits and values. Beyond these theoretical contribu- tions, our review and framework offer practical guidance for entrepreneurs seeking to use GenAI strategically while man- aging its risks. Managerial Summary: We review how GenAI influences entrepreneurs at each stage of the entrepreneurial process: opportunity recognition and ideation, opportunity evalua- tion and commitment, resource assembly and mobilization, and venture launch and growth. Based on this review, we propose the Empowerment–Entrapment Framework to help entrepreneurs understand GenAI's trade-offs at each stage. The future of entrepreneur-

ship will depend less on whether entrepreneurs use GenAI than on how they use it. Used thoughtfully, GenAI may empower entrepreneurs by expan- ding their capabilities to engage in entrepreneurial activities. Used uncritically, GenAI may entrap entrepreneurs by restricting or eroding those capabilities. Entrepreneurs should therefore verify what GenAI produces, calibrate GenAI use to their expertise and task demands, and decide which tasks to delegate to GenAI while retaining human judgment for consequential decisions. K E Y W O R D S entrepreneurial process, entrepreneurship,...

 Lu - Generative AI use in entrepreneurship An integrative review and the Empowerment–.pdf

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3. Conceptual search: A generative view of entrepreneurial imagination

Authors: Felipe A. Csaszar
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70055
Published: 2026-10-25

Keywords: artificial intelligence, conceptual search, entrepreneurial cognition, entrepreneurial imagination, genetic algorithm

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Artificial Intelligence in Entrepreneurship, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** Entrepreneurial Imagination, Search Theory, Evolutionary Theory, Generative View

Abstract:

Research Summary: Entrepreneurs cannot pursue ventures they never imagine. This article develops a generative view of entrepreneurial imagination as the construction of an evolving candidate set through generation, provisional eval- uation, and revision. Conceptual search represents venture concepts as text, transforms them through interpretable operations, and compares their promise. A large language model prototype demonstrates complementary modes: local refinement lifts a concept from sixteenth to third among 30 ventures under a validated evaluator, while global recombination reaches distant possibilities that refinement makes competitive. The framework shows how search architecture determines what enters, survives, and develops, and how AI may broaden imagination within firms while producing correlated imagination across firms. By making imagination programmable, auditable, and experi- mentally tractable, conceptual search opens a research pro- gram on how entrepreneurial possibilities are constructed. Managerial Summary: Entrepreneurs can pursue only the ventures they imagine, and valuable ideas routinely go unbuilt because nobody thinks of them. AI makes imagining cheap: it can draft, critique, and rewrite venture concepts in seconds, so developing ideas becomes a process that can be Received: 22 September 2026 Revised: 22 September 2026 Accepted: 24 September 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70055 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–35. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 designed, run, and audited. I demonstrate a system that evo- lves real venture concepts: step-by-step refinement lifted a middling concept to third place among 30 real ventures, as ranked by an AI judge shown to predict fundraising, while recombining distant ideas created novel concepts that refinement made competitive. The entrepreneur's job shifts from generating a few ideas to governing many: choosing what to search, keep, and test in the market. One caution: rivals using the same AI will imagine similar ventures; advan- tage comes from proprietary problems, data, and evidence. K E Y W O R D S artificial intelligence, conceptual search, entrepreneurial cognition, entrepreneurial imagination, genetic algorithm "If you want to have good ideas you must have many ideas." —Linus Pauling 1 |

 Csaszar - Conceptual search A generative view of entrepreneurial imagination.pdf

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4. "Borrowing intelligence to build a business" : The promise of open-source AI for entrepreneurship

Authors: Georg von Krogh, Ann-Kristin Weiser, Patrick Nicolas Tinguely
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70052
Published: 2026-10-23

Keywords: entry barriers, market entry, new ventures, open-source artificial intelligence, private-collective innovation

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Innovation Ecosystems, International Business
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Institutional Theory, Private-Collective Innovation, Openness Paradox

Abstract:

Research Summary: Open-source artificial intelligence (OSAI) is an increasingly important yet poorly understood frontier for entrepreneurial activity. We identify four defin- ing features that shape new ventures' engagement with OSAI communities: dependence on sponsoring firms, lay- ered licensing regimes, regulatory risks, and nation-state influence. We develop the OSAI Framework for Market Entry to explain how open-weight models relocate, rather than merely lower, entry barriers across six domains in AI- enabled product and service markets. They may reduce resource barriers but create dependence on the governance of borrowed components, shifting the binding constraint from technical to commercial entry and value capture through complementary assets. We discuss contributions to research on entrepreneurial entry and strategy, private- collective innovation, the openness paradox, and the new venture life cycle, and outline directions for future research. Managerial Summary: Open-source artificial intelligence (OSAI) offers new ventures access to powerful resources for developing AI-enabled products and services without building AI capabilities from scratch. Yet new ventures must often contend with four key governance dependencies that shape how they engage with OSAI communities: reliance on large technology firms that contribute and steer critical Received: 17 September 2026 Revised: 17 September 2026 Accepted: 24 September 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70052 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–27. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 layers of the AI stack, licensing terms that vary by layer, emerging regulatory requirements, and growing nation- state influence over OSAI. Our OSAI Framework for Market Entry identifies where OSAI can lower entry barriers, where constraints shift instead, and how new ventures can man- age the trade-offs resulting from governance dependencies. It helps new ventures and investors evaluate when, where, and how to build on OSAI components, and which comple- mentary assets can protect their returns. K E Y W O R D S entry barriers, market entry, new ventures, open-source artificial intelligence, private-collective innovation 1 |

 Krogh - "Borrowing intelligence to build a business" The promise of open-source AI for e.pdf

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5. Everything everywhere all-at-once? AI, expertise–output decoupling, and new entrepreneurial strategy trade-offs in the age of abundance

Authors: Jen Gennai, Riitta Katila, Minu Kumar, Ian Sinapuelas
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70065
Published: 2026-10-22

Keywords: AI, AI governance, entrepreneurial search, generative artificial intelligence, human expertise, innovation, organizational design, strategic trade-offs, strategy

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Human-AI Interaction
- **Theories:** Organizational Design, Attention-Based View, Expertise-Output Decoupling, Governance Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Generative AI democratizes entrepre- neurship by lowering barriers to ideation, creating an envi- ronment of abundance. Yet while AI produces speed, scale, and local autonomy, these benefits may come at hidden costs to output quality. Using illustrative vignettes to gro- und and elaborate, we particularly identify explainability, traceability, and generalizability as costs of abundance. As AI separates observable output from the expertise tradition- ally required to produce it, the entrepreneur's attention to evaluation becomes the scarce resource. We identify three trade-offs and their interdependencies for entrepreneurs: speed-to-understanding, scale-to-oversight, and local autonomy-to-system-wide relevance. Implications for human accountability of AI systems and governance (organi- zational design) challenges for entrepreneurs are discussed. Managerial Summary: AI allows entrepreneurial firms to produce ideas and other outputs faster and at greater scale Received: 18 September 2026 Revised: 18 September 2026 Accepted: 5 October 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70065 © 2026 Strategic Management Society. All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–15. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 than ever before. As AI separates output from the expertise traditionally gained while creating it, the scarce resource shifts from generation to evaluation. This creates new man- agerial tensions: speed versus understanding, scale versus oversight, and local autonomy versus system-wide rele- vance. These tensions help explain concerns about AI "going rogue": simply keeping a human in the loop is not enough if the human expertise no longer includes the ability to under- stand, trace, question, and override the system. Entrepre- neurs are challenged to design organizations that preserve meaningful human expertise and accountability. K E Y W O R D S AI, AI governance, entrepreneurial search, generative artificial intelligence, human expertise, innovation, organizational design, strategic trade-offs, strategy "Trade-offs are essential to strategy. They create the need for choice and purposefully limit what a company offers." (Porter, 1996, p. 69) 1 |

 Gennai - Everything everywhere all-at-once AI, expertise—output decoupling, and new entre.pdf

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6. Generative AI and the ability of entrepreneurial opportunities to generate sustained competitive advantages

Authors: Haiyang Zhang, Robert Wuebker, Jay B. Barney
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70064
Published: 2026-10-21

Keywords: competitive neglect, entrepreneurial opportunities, generative artificial intelligence, sustained competitive advantage, unawareness rents

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Competitive Strategy
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Opportunity Discovery and Creation, Knightian Uncertainty, Competitive Dynamics

Abstract:

Research Summary This paper examines how generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) affects the ability of entrepreneurial opportunities to generate sustained competitive advantage. We argue that GenAI's impact is conditional on how those opportunities are formed. Discovery opportunities originate from exogenous industry shocks. However, widely available GenAI tools are likely to commoditize opportunity recognition in these settings and thus reduce advantages that might have been generated by exploiting these opportunities. Creation opportunities emerge endogenously, under conditions of Knightian uncertainty, through entrepreneurial action and interaction with the environment. However, GenAI cannot fully resolve the Knightian uncertainty inherent in creation settings, so sustained advantage here depends on whether resources and capabilities developed through creating an opportunity are inimitable. Unawareness opportunities rely on competitive neglect. GenAI may reduce the advantages of firms in these settings when it makes rents legible to potential competitors and when search is directed toward these invisible markets. Managerial Summary Generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) tools like ChatGPT and Claude help entrepreneurs spot opportunities, but every competitor can potentially access the same tools. Whether GenAI can create sustained competitive advantages, this paper argues, depends on how an opportunity is formed. When opportunities arise from entrepreneurs noticing an external market shift, GenAI levels the playing field by commoditizing recognition

and pushes entrepreneurs to win through execution and hard-to-copy complements. When opportunities are created through actions and interactions of entrepreneurs with their environments, GenAI does not fully remove the uncertainty that makes these efforts entrepreneurial but can speed up experimentation. When opportunities emerge from entrepreneurs operating in markets neglected by competitors, GenAI may have a limited effect on advantage unless it makes invisible markets publicly known.

 Zhang - Generative AI and the ability of entrepreneurial opportunities to generate susta.pdf

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7. Framing the unknowable: The role of language and frame multiplicity in early-stage startup pitches

Authors: Ann-Sophie Kowalewski
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70053
Published: 2026-10-20

Keywords: entrepreneurial framing, growth, novelty, startup pitches

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Communication, Entrepreneurial Finance
- **Theories:** Framing Theory, Rhetorical Theory, Signaling Theory, Frame Multiplicity

Abstract:

Research Summary: Early-stage startup pitches must make largely unknowable futures plausible. As such, they bear a rhetorical burden. This study theorizes how multiple frames jointly shape this burden and, consequently, affect investor evaluations. Specifically, it considers how future growth frames interact with concreteness and novelty frames. Evi- dence from 618 startup pitches and ad-hoc investor evalua- tions reveals that growth frames relying more on entrepreneurs' own assertions than on established grounds tend to receive lower investor evaluations. This evaluative discount is alleviated when growth is expressed concretely but becomes more pronounced when the pitch emphasizes novelty. These findings extend framing theory by explaining the relevance and possible implications of frame multiplicity in pitches and entrepreneurial communication more broadly. Managerial Summary: Mobilizing support for a new venture is difficult because founders must often describe a future that does not yet exist. This study of 618 startup pitches shows that growth-related messages can shape investor evaluations even at the earliest stage, but only if configured well. Because growth frames must appear plausible amid Received: 31 January 2025 Revised: 12 September 2026 Accepted: 25 September 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70053 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited and is not used for commercial purposes. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–30. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 the uncertainty surrounding new startups, framing early- stage startups around growth is rhetorically burdensome. Findings show that pitches are evaluated less favorably when they rely more on founders' own projections and rea- soning than on established grounds such as market analyses. Concrete language can alleviate this burden, while novelty framing intensifies it. As such, this study reveals intricate and potentially unintended interactions among multiple frames within a single pitch. K E Y W O R D S entrepreneurial framing, growth, novelty, startup pitches 1 |

 Kowalewski - Framing the unknowable The role of language and frame multiplicity in early-stag.pdf

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8. When machines learn with organizations: AI-enabled knowledge creation and entrepreneurship

Authors: Linhui Wu, Shaker A. Zahra, Niron Hashai
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70062
Published: 2026-10-20

Keywords: closed Gen-AI, entrepreneurship, innovation, knowledge creation

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Entrepreneurship, Knowledge Management, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** Knowledge-Based View, Organizational Learning, Human-AI Hybridity

Abstract:

Research Summary: To promote entrepreneurship and new business development, firms will increasingly rely on new forms of knowledge creation to manage environments mar- ked by technological change and radical uncertainty. We argue that as generative artificial intelligence (Gen-AI) becomes embedded in organizational processes, knowledge creation will no longer remain solely a human activity. Instead, it will increasingly emerge from hybrid interactions between human actors and firm-specific, closed Gen-AI systems. These systems begin to participate directly in how knowledge is generated, recombined, internalized, shared, and converted into entrepreneurial initiatives such as corpo- rate entrepreneurship, spin-offs, and new business models. We also reconceptualize organizational knowledge creation as a hybrid human–AI process and propose a reordered knowledge creation cycle that induces multiple knowledge spirals, captures the emergence of new agents, and the gen- eration of diverse types of knowledge, with faster temporal Received: 17 September 2026 Revised: 17 September 2026 Accepted: 1 October 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70062 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–22. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 dynamics. Building on this perspective, we offer a research agenda for future scholarship. Managerial Summary: We discuss how firm-specific gener- ative AI systems are likely to fundamentally alter the ways firms generate knowledge, respond to change, and sustain long-term renewal. We propose that rather than replacing human judgment, closed Gen-AI changes where knowledge originates as well as how quickly it evolves, and how broadly it circulates across organizational boundaries. This means that the managerial challenge is less about adopting AI and more about designing knowledge systems and structuring knowledge flows. Executives and entrepreneurs alike need to decide how to structure human–AI collaborations, how much autonomy to grant closed Gen-AI systems, and how to prevent speed from overwhelming sensemaking. Our work underscores that although hybrid knowledge creation promises faster and more diverse learning, it also introduces risks related to opacity, trust, and cognitive lock-in. Firms that deliberately orchestrate the role of closed Gen-AI in their learning systems will be better positioned to shape future advantage by promoting innovation and entrepre- neurial activities of different types. K E Y W O R D S closed Gen-AI, entrepreneurship, innovation, knowledge creation 1...

 Wu - When machines learn with organizations AI-enabled knowledge creation and entrepr.pd

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General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. Craft and Industrialization: Uncovering the Plasticity and Frontier of Craft

Authors: Mirva Peltoniemi, Antti Sihvonen
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70183
Published: 2026-10-25

Keywords: craft, craft frontier, engineering, industrialization, plasticity

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Innovation Management, Sociology of Work
- **Theories:** Institutional Logics, Craft Logic, Organizational Plasticity

Abstract:

Craft as an approach to work has been proposed as an alternative to industrial mass production. While industrialization has led to the replacement of craft logic with industrial logic to create uniformity and scale operations, the role of craft in industrialization remains ambiguous. Building on the analysis of engineering work performed at an R&D laboratory in the pulp and paper industry, we explore how and why craft

enables industrialization. Our findings reveal how elements of craft manifest in engineering work by helping to transform ideas into useful objects, balancing scientific accuracy with practical usefulness, and fostering a sense of community and identity within the engineering field. These findings point to the plasticity of craft logic , suggesting that elements of craft can be transferred into new contexts and reinterpreted to address new objectives. Considering that these activities took place in an R&D laboratory that drove industrialization, they also reveal the existence of a craft frontier that escapes standardization by providing a context for crafting candidates for future standards. Craft frontier enables the coexistence of craft and industrial logics, where craft can contribute to industrialization by establishing foundations for managerial control without being absorbed into it.

 Peltoniemi - Craft and Industrialization Uncovering the Plasticity and Frontier of Craft.pdf

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2. It's in the Small Steps: Navigating Knotted Change-Stability Tensions in Complex Collaborations

Authors: Lea Stadtler, Luk N. Van Wassenhove
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70181
Published: 2026-10-21

Keywords: change, cross-sector partnerships, grand challenges, humanitarian, interorganizational collaboration, knotted paradoxes

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Inter-organizational Collaboration, Organizational Change
- **Theories:** Paradox Theory, Process Theory, Collective-Individual Tensions

Abstract:

Addressing societal challenges requires collaborative arrangements that can adapt to changing environments while maintaining coherence. Existing research highlights collaborative responses to change, yet the processes through which such responses emerge remain poorly understood. Notably, collaborative change involves not only balancing change and stability but also navigating knotted collective-individual tensions that arise in realigning interests, coordination structures, and operations. To advance understanding of these dynamics, we conduct an in-depth longitudinal study of collaborative change in a cross-sector disaster relief partnership. Across successive change stages, we identify stability drivers emerging from collective-individual tensions that prompted the partners to adopt specific balancing practices. These practices enabled a change process that was incremental and fragile in progression, yet resilient in its cumulative pattern. We develop a process model that explains the dynamics of collaborative change and shows how balancing change and stability enables partners to progressively broaden and occasionally transcend collective-individual alignment as trust and mutual understanding deepen. This study advances collaboration and paradox theory by exposing balancing practices tailored to collaborative settings that enable adaptation in dynamic environments and by proposing a gradual approach to navigating knotted paradoxes.

 Stadtler - It's in the Small Steps Navigating Knotted Change-Stability Tensions in Complex.pdf

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3. CEO Ideologically (In)Congruent Activism and Investor Reactions: An Attribution of CEO Intentions Perspective

Authors: Miao Yun, Longwang Fu
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70175
Published: 2026-10-16

Keywords: CEO activism, investor reactions, managerial incongruent behaviours, political ideology

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Non-market Strategy
- **Theories:** Attribution Theory, Signaling Theory, Investor Reactions

Abstract:

The phenomenon of chief executive officers (CEOs) taking activism stances on contested sociopolitical issues is increasing, yet it remains unclear how observing investors discern CEO intentions behind activism engagements, thereby shaping their judgments and subsequent reactions. By relaxing the assumption that CEO activism is an unabashed expression of personal beliefs, we propose the concept of CEO ideologically (in)congruent activism and develop a framework wherein investors may attribute CEO intentions underlying incongruent (versus congruent) activism engagements as more organization-driven (versus self-driven) interest pursuits, thereby leading to more positive investor evaluations and reactions. Furthermore, we argue that the positive effect of CEO ideologically incongruent activism on investor reactions will be amplified when the CEO owns a higher level of stock ownership but weakened when the firm receives a greater corporate social responsibility (CSR) rating. We corroborate our propositions using a sample of CEO activism events for S&P 500 firms from 2012 to 2021. Our findings demonstrate the heterogeneity and critical influence of CEO intentions behind activism engagements and shed light on how investors integrate multi-informational cues when evaluating and reacting to managerial incongruent behaviours.

 Yun - CEO Ideologically (In)Congruent Activism and Investor Reactions An Attribution o.pdf

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Journal of Management

1. A Moral Foundations Perspective on CEO Political Ideology

Authors: Moritz Appels, Marc Kowalzick, Michael Woywode
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261489261
Published: 2026-10-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Leadership, Corporate Governance, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Upper Echelons Theory, Moral Foundations Theory, Motivated Cognition

Abstract:

As a reflection of their fundamental value systems, CEOs' political ideology has come to be regarded as a major predictor of their strategic decision-making. Among the most persistent characterizations in this literature, liberal-leaning CEOs are considered to exhibit a distinct preference for evenhanded outcomes and pro-social corporate practices due to their ideological endorsement of equality—an association derived from the conceptualization of political ideolo gies along the motivated cognition perspective and routinely used to differentiate them from their more conservative peers. Yet, moral psychologists increasingly call for a broader under standing of the moral values differentiating liberals and conservatives. We therefore introduce moral foundations theory to the study of CEO political ideology, according to which liberaland conservative-leaning CEOs differ in their focus on individualversus group-centric concerns but, contrary to the existing consensus, should both endorse evenhanded outcomes and prosocial corporate practices. We find evidence for corresponding U-shaped rather than linear effects of CEOs' political ideology in a sample of over 1,600 S&P 1500 CEOs. As such, we offer a novel theoretical perspective on CEOs' political ideology and its organizational ramifications. Keywords: political ideology; upper echelons; moral foundations theory; strategic leader ship; CEO decision-making

 Appels - A Moral Foundations Perspective on CEO Political Ideology.pdf

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2. Competitive Dormancy in Interfirm Rivalry: Consequences for Rival Actions

Authors: Tianxu Chen, Jianhong Chen, Lingling Pan, Wenpin Tsai, Ming-Jer Chen
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261492636
Published: 2026-10-30

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Competitive Dynamics
- **Theories:** Expectancy Violation Theory, Competitive Dynamics Research

Abstract:

In this study, we examine the implications of competitive dormancy, defined as a situation in which a focal firm' s observed time span of inaction following its prior action has exceeded the firm' s typical duration between successive actions. We argue that competitive dormancy may be perceived as inconsistent with a rival' s expectations and may be associated with an interpretive process concerning the rival' s subsequent actions. Integrating expectancy violation theory (EVT) and competitive dynamics research, we propose that the relationship between a focal firm' s competitive dormancy and the likelihood of rivals' subsequent actions varies with their relative market standing and strategic resource commitment. Using a sample of 78,055 daily observations from 28 firms across 14 industries from 2000 to 2017, we find support for our hypotheses.

 Chen - Competitive Dormancy in Interfirm Rivalry Consequences for Rival Actions.pdf

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3. "The Minimum Wage Is the Maximum Wage" : How Goal Replacement Perpetuates Means–Ends Decoupling

Authors: Satwant Dahiya, Christian Busse
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261487366
Published: 2026-10-26

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, International Business, Corporate Social Responsibility
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Means-Ends Decoupling, Goal Replacement Mechanism

Abstract:

This research examines how organizations contribute to the perpetuation of means–ends decoupling (MED) within issue-based fields organized around societal problems, under condi tions of heightened field scrutiny. In such settings, organizations often profess commitment to field goals and visibly comply with institutionally prescribed practices to satisfy monitoring, reporting, and public evaluation requirements. However, many adopted goals remain under achieved, raising questions about how compliance without progress endures and how claims of commitment remain credible under transparency regimes intended to spur substantive goal pursuit. Our data came from 75 interviews with 68 brands, suppliers, and third-party organiza tions pursuing worker well-being in global fashion supply chains. We unveil auditability-based goal replacement as an organizational-level mechanism through which actors rhetorically foreground compliance as public evidence of commitment while narrowing internal goal pur suit to auditable thresholds that serve their core goals, thereby allowing shortfalls to persist. Self-silencing about this substitution and the instrumentalizing of shortfalls close the configu ration into a self-reinforcing loop. The study advances MED scholarship by (i) showing how organizations leverage field conditions and appropriate the existing scrutiny infrastructures to advance their core goals while reproducing the means–ends gap, (ii) problematizing the Acknowledgments: We are indebted to the action editor Fabrice Lumineau and two anonymous reviewers for their highly devel- opmental and constructive feedback. We further thank Frank Wijen, Elke Schüßler, Miriam Wilhelm, Juliane Reinecke, Ruthanne Huising, Beatrice D' Ippolito, and Nora Lohmeyer, as well as the reviewers and par- ticipants of the 83rd Academy of Management conference held in Boston, MA, whose valuable comments and sug gestions helped shape this work. Finally, we thank our interviewees, whose participation made this study possible. Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Satwant Dahiya, Department of Business Administration, Economics and Law, Carl von Ossietzky University of Oldenburg, Ammerländer Heerstr. 114-118, Oldenburg, 26129, Germany.

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4. Winning at Defense by Playing Offense: Discrediting by Target Firms in Activist Hedge Fund Campaigns

Authors: Matthias Brauer, Marc J. Mertens, Louis Vandepoele
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261479303

Published: 2026-10-28

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Shareholder Activism
- **Theories:** Impression Management Theory

Abstract:

Prior research highlights the far-reaching strategic and governance consequences for firms tar geted in activist hedge fund (AHF) campaigns. Yet, how target firm executives and directors can effectively defend against these campaigns remains underexplored. Drawing on impression man agement (IM) theory, we reason that executives and directors use discrediting in their public rebuttal letters to negatively influence shareholders' evaluations of AHFs' reputation. To nuance this prediction, we develop a taxonomy distinguishing between source-focused discrediting, which directly attacks AHFs' reputation, and message-focused discrediting, which challenges the validity of AHFs' claims to indirectly tarnish their reputation. We theorize that both discrediting subtypes enhance target firms' defense success, particularly when deployed in combination. Adopting a temporal perspective on IM theory, we further argue that the effectiveness of discrediting dimin ishes as more time elapses between an AHF' s public attack and executives and directors' rebuttal. A manual content analysis of 841 rebuttal letters issued during U.S. AHF campaigns (2000–2023) provides robust support for these predictions. Beyond contributing to shareholder activism research by offering new insights into the determinants of campaign outcomes, our study advances IM theory by conceptualizing discrediting as a multidimensional influence tactic and exploring its effectiveness and temporal dynamics in adversarial contexts.

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